THE PLOT MAKER

SYAM PUSHKARAN, 37

Scriptwriter



Writer Syam Pushkaran is possibly one of the best creative contributors in Malayalam movies today. The list of films he has contributed to include *Maheshinte Prathikaram*, *Thondimuthalum Driksakshiyum*, *Mayanadhi*, *Kumbalangi Nights*, *Rani Padmini* and *Joji*. Fahadh Faasil might be a star actor today and every film of his an event even outside Kerala but Syam Pushkaran and his screenplays have had a big hand in the making of that phenomenon. Be it the films of Dileesh Pothan, Aashiq Abu or Madhu C. Narayanan, Syam's scripts are studied and analysed by fans and critics with special care. Syam won the National Award for Best Original Screenplay for *Maheshinte Prathikaram*. His next project where he is co-producer and writer is *Thankam*, directed by Saheedh Arafath. ■

–Aditya Shrikrishna

PHONE LIFE Syam loves to shoot videos on his phone during shoots, a lot of which make it to the YouTube channel 'Bhavana Studios', incidentally the name of the studio of Mahesh, one of his most iconic creations

"In Malayalam cinema, we can experiment a lot... People like the masala movies but they also like the contemplative films we make"

SYAM PUSHKARAN
to The Indian Express

LIVING ON THE EDGE

KARTHICK NAREN, 28

Filmmaker



Karthick Naren announced himself with *Dhuruvangal Pathinaaru*, a Tamil crime procedural that put writing, characters and filmmaking over stars and set pieces. Not often does a debut filmmaker come into the limelight with a tried and tested genre and yet create an impact that's as new as it is refreshing. At a time when most young aspiring filmmakers were still writing or making short films, Naren had already made a solid first feature that was both a critical and commercial success. Naren quickly made a sophomore feature, *Naragasooran*, that unfortunately got stuck in release limbo. He then made *Mafia: Chapter 1* that put style on the frontburner with a promise of a sequel for the fans. He's now working on a film with Dhanush—*Maaran*—and quickly trying to establish himself as one of those filmmakers who can leave his stamp even in a film headlined by a star. ■

–Aditya Shrikrishna

"I'll complete five years in the film industry soon. It's been a roller-coaster ride and I can't wait to see what's in store for me in the next two years"

TENDER SHOOTS Karthick Naren was just 22 when his first feature film came out